



Department of Computer Science

香港城市大學  
City University of Hong Kong

# Department of Computer Science Master's Programme Orientation 2026

## MSc Artificial Intelligence (MSAI)

Prof ZHANG Qingfu (Programme Leader)  
Prof LIAO Jing (Deputy Programme Leader)

# Congratulations

## Warm Welcome



- ✓ Recognitions and Achievements of CityUHK and CS
  - One of the best universities for CS (US News, QS, etc.)
  - World-leading excellence in applied research
  - World-class staff: Highly cited active researchers
- ✓ Feeds to teaching: Knowledge at the frontier
  - Research elements in relevant courses
  - Mini-research experience in Guided Study / Project courses



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# Programme Objectives

Upgrade technical capabilities in Artificial Intelligence

Build technical competence

Reinforce technology foundations

Develop technical leadership

Prepare for further advanced studies



# Curriculum Overview

Medium of instruction: **ENGLISH**

**Credit Units  
Required for  
Graduation**

**31 Credit units**



Core: 4 courses (10 Credit units)



Electives: 7 courses (21 Credit units)

**Study  
Period**

**Full time : 1 - 2.5 years**

**Full time (with year-long internship/project course): 2 - 3 years**

**Part-time/Combined mode (for local students): 2 - 5 years**

# 4 Core Courses

**CS5486 Intelligence Systems**

**CS5489 Machine Learning: Algorithms and Applications**

**CS5491 Artificial Intelligence**

**CS5611 Seminar on AI Ethics**



Make up for AI knowledge that some students missed



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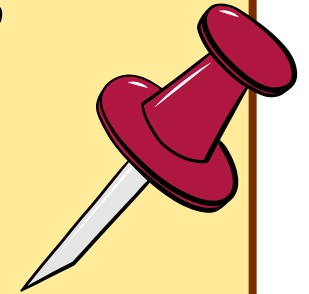
# 3 Study Streams

Autonomous Driving (AD)

Generative AI (GAI)

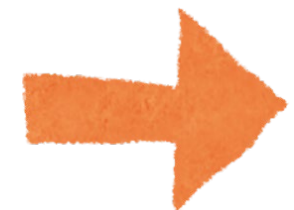
Trustworthy AI (TAI)

Stream name shown  
in **transcript ONLY**,  
**NOT** in graduate  
certificate



Students may choose to:

- ✓ take any Electives **without concentration** on any stream
- ✓ concentrate on a stream by taking **12 credit units** of the stream courses (including 2 stream core courses + 1 stream elective), **AND** no more than **3 credit units** of courses from other streams



**Declare your study stream in Semester B**

# Autonomous Driving (AD) Stream

Explore the AI technologies behind autonomous vehicles & intelligent transportation, including perception, decision-making & reinforcement learning.

## Stream Core:

- **CS5493** Topics in Autonomous Driving (**Sem B**)
- **SDSC6007** Dynamic Programming and Reinforcement Learning (**Sem B**)

## Stream Elective (either one):

- **CS6522** Project in Autonomous Driving
- **CS6523** Internship in Autonomous Driving (6 CUs)
- **CS6539** Internship in Autonomous Driving (3 CUs)



Contact for  
academic advice



**Prof. GUAN Nan**



nanguan@cityu.edu.hk



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# Generative AI (GAI) Stream

Learn to build advanced AI models that create text, images, and other content, with a focus on large language models and generative technologies.

## Stream Core:

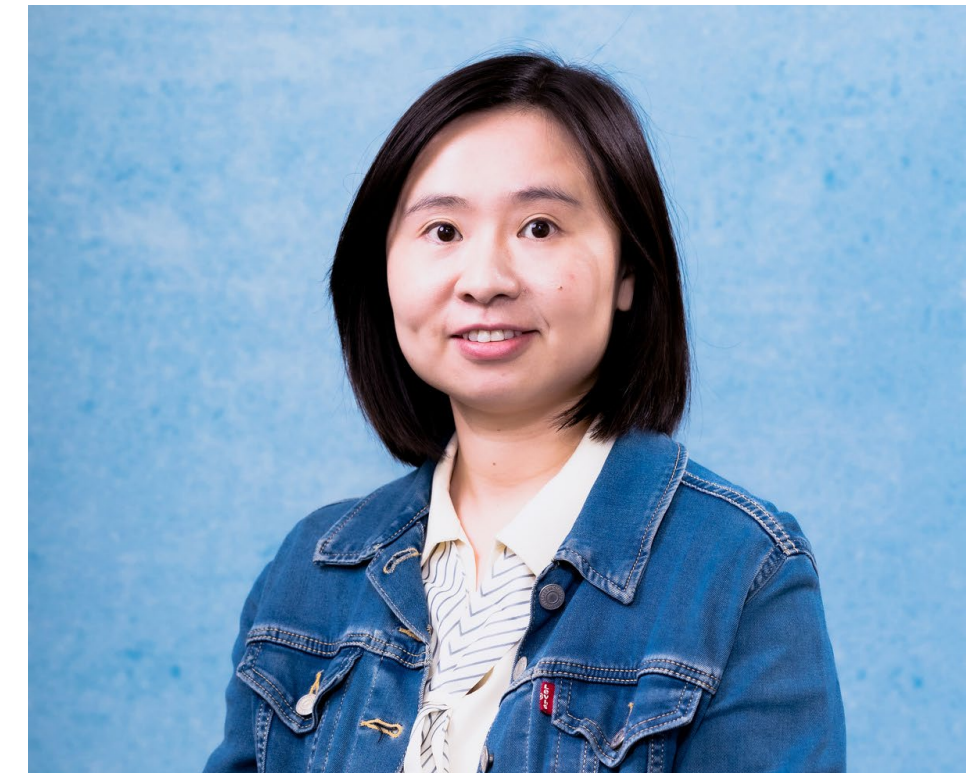
- **CS6493** Natural Language Processing (Sem B)
- **CS5494** Topics in Generative AI (Sem A)

## Stream Elective (either one):

- **CS6524** Project in Generative AI
- **CS6525** Internship in Generative AI (6 CUs)
- **CS6540** Internship in Generative AI (3 CUs)



Contact for  
academic advice



**Prof. LIAO Jing**



jingliao@cityu.edu.hk



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# Trustworthy AI (TAI) Stream

Develop expertise in explainable, secure, and ethical AI systems, enabling responsible and reliable deployment of AI solutions.

## Stream Core:

- **CS5495** Explainable AI (Sem A)
- **CS5297** Topics in AI Security (Sem B)

## Stream Elective (either one):

- **CS6526** Project in Trustworthy AI
- **CS6527** Internship in Trustworthy AI (6 CUs)
- **CS6541** Internship in Trustworthy AI (3 CUs)



Contact for  
academic advice



**Prof. MA Chen**



chenma@cityu.edu.hk



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# CS6535 Guided Study in AI

A research-oriented course **(3 credit units)** :

- Offer in Sem B and Summer Term
- Individual project (no group project is allowed)
- CGPA requirements: MUST attain a CGPA  $\geq 3.30$



Contact for  
academic advice



**Prof. Junhui HOU**

 [jh.hou@cityu.edu.hk](mailto:jh.hou@cityu.edu.hk)



**High demand + Limited quota**



Contact your potential supervisor in Sem A  
even if you intend to take the course in Sem B



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# CS6522/ CS6524/ CS6526/ CS6529 Project Course

A research-oriented course:

- **Across 2 semesters**
- **6 credit units (3 CUs/ Sem)**
- Offer in Sem B and Summer Term **(for Year 1)**
- Offer in Sem A and Sem B **(for Year 2)**
- Individual project (no group project is allowed)
- CGPA requirements: MUST attain a CGPA  $\geq 3.30$



Contact for  
academic advice



**Prof. Junhui HOU**

 [jh.hou@cityu.edu.hk](mailto:jh.hou@cityu.edu.hk)

Select a  
research  
topic

Find a CS  
supervisor

Send info to  
Prof. Hou +  
prog. admin for  
enrollment

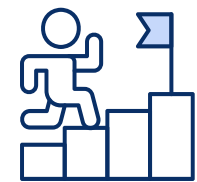


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# Internship Courses

**Summer Term (3 CUs):**  
**CS6542/ CS6539/ CS6540/ CS6541**

**Sem A + Sem B of Year 2 (6 CUs):**  
**CS6528/ CS6523/ CS6525/ CS6527**



## Objectives:

- Provide an opportunity for students to explore individually an area of CS
- Allow students to develop their skills and knowledge further in the area of interest
- Provide the context for students to demonstrate their ability to integrate specialized knowledge that they have acquired and apply them to solve an advanced problem with a working solution

## Requirements

**completed at least 22 credit units**  
**(including all core courses)**

## Exclusive Courses

**ALL Project courses**



More details to be announced via email

# Sample Study Plans

Full-time 1-Year Study Plan 1 (Expected graduation month: June 2027)

| Semester A |                                               | Credit Units | Semester B |                              | Credit Units |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------|------------|------------------------------|--------------|
| CS5486     | Intelligence Systems                          | 3            | CS5491     | Artificial Intelligence      | 3            |
| CS5489     | Machine Learning: Algorithms and Applications | 3            | CS5611     | Seminar on AI Ethics         | 1            |
| Electives  | 3 courses from the electives                  | 9            | Electives  | 4 courses from the electives | 12           |

# Sample Study Plans

## Full-time 1-Year Study Plan 2 (Expected graduation month: October 2027)

| Semester A |                                               | Credit Units | Semester B |                              | Credit Units | Summer Term |                | Credit Units |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------|------------|------------------------------|--------------|-------------|----------------|--------------|
| CS5486     | Intelligence Systems                          | 3            | CS5491     | Artificial Intelligence      | 3            | Electives   | Project course | 3            |
| CS5489     | Machine Learning: Algorithms and Applications | 3            | CS5611     | Seminar on AI Ethics         | 1            |             |                |              |
| Electives  | 3 courses from the electives                  | 9            | Electives  | 2 courses from the electives | 6            |             |                |              |
|            |                                               |              | Electives  | Project course               | 3            |             |                |              |

# Sample Study Plans

## Full-time 2-Year Study Plan (Expected graduation month: June 2028)

### Year 1

| Semester A |                                               | Credit Units | Semester B |                              | Credit Units |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------|------------|------------------------------|--------------|
| CS5486     | Intelligence Systems                          | 3            | CS5491     | Artificial Intelligence      | 3            |
| CS5489     | Machine Learning: Algorithms and Applications | 3            | CS5611     | Seminar on AI Ethics         | 1            |
| Electives  | 3 courses from the electives                  | 9            | Electives  | 2 courses from the electives | 6            |

### Year 2

| Semester A |                            | Credit Units | Semester B |                            | Credit Units |
|------------|----------------------------|--------------|------------|----------------------------|--------------|
| Electives  | Internship/Project course* | 3            | Electives  | Internship/Project course* | 3            |

*\* All the Project courses and internship courses are mutually exclusive*

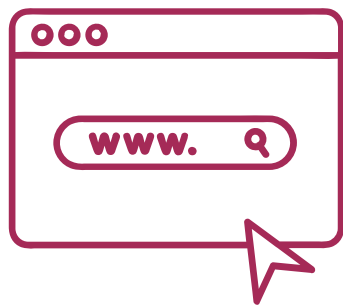
# Course Registration

4 core courses  
(10 credit units)

**Pre-registered for you**

Elective courses  
(21 credit units)

**Add/Drop online**  
**Deadline: 7 Sep 2026**



**Course syllabi**

<https://www.cityu.edu.hk/catalogue/pg/202627/programme/MSAI.htm>



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# Add/Drop of Web-enabled Courses



Details of the course registration arrangements:

<https://www.cityu.edu.hk/sgs/student/masters/coursereg/web>



Web Registration Demos:

<https://www.cityu.edu.hk/sgs/student/masters/coursereg/guide#03>



**24 August - 7 September 2026**



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# Add/Drop of Non Web-enabled Courses

**Login to  
AIMS**

**Select the  
Course  
Registration  
menu**

**Click Application for  
Add/Drop of Non-  
Web-enabled Course  
& Study Load  
Adjustment**

**Click the  
"Add/Drop  
Course" button  
at the bottom**



Details of the course registration arrangements:

<https://www.cityu.edu.hk/sgs/student/masters/coursereg/non-web>



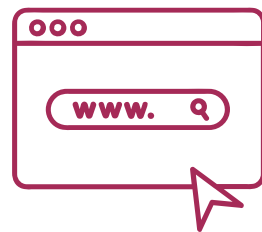
**10 August - 7 September 2026**



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# Credit Transfer

- ✓ **Core Courses ONLY (CS5486, CS5489, CS5491, CS5611)**
- ✓ Up to 9 credits might be transferred
- ✓ Approval based on
  - Relevance of previous advanced course taken at a **postgraduate level**
  - Good grade
- ✓ **Need to attend classes until formally approved**



Visit the SGS website for the application procedure:

<https://www.cityu.edu.hk/sgs/student/masters/records/credittransfer>



**Application Deadline 28 August 2026**



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# Course Exemption

✓ Core Courses ONLY (CS5486, CS5489, CS5491, CS5611)

✓ Credit units are **NOT earned**

➔ Take an elective course as replacement

✓ Approval based on

- Relevance of previous advanced course taken at **senior undergraduate level**
- Good grade

✓ Need to attend classes until formally approved

⌚! **Application Deadline 28 August 2026**



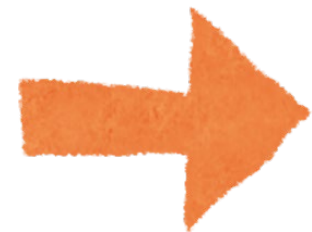
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# Study Load



**Non-local students: Full -time study mode**

**MUST** abide by the condition of stay of their student visa

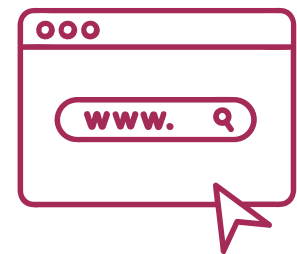


**At least 12 credit units in each semester**



**If you do not take any courses in a semester**

**MUST** apply for “Leave of Absence”



Details:

<https://www.cityu.edu.hk/sgs/student/tpg>



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# Face-to-Face Learning Requirement

- ✓ All learning and teaching activities = **face-to-face mode**
- ✓ **Physically present** in Hong Kong throughout your period of study



## Enquiries from Chinese Service Center for Scholarly Exchange (CSCSE)

Mainland authority responsible for the verification and recognition of  
qualifications obtained outside mainland China

- ✓ Monitor immigration and travel records of students



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# Importance of Maintaining Physical Presence

Failure to maintain the required physical presence in Hong Kong during your studies may:

-  Affect the recognition and verification of your academic qualifications by mainland authorities, including CSCSE;
-  Jeopardise the recognition of your degree or academic credentials; and
-  Lead to complications when applying for degree verification or related assessments in the future



**Attend all classes  
physically in campus**



# Award



Minimum CGPA 2.00 to graduate



Degree Classifications:

- Distinction (3.50+)
- Credit (3.20 – 3.49)
- Pass (2.00 – 3.19)



**Having “Marginal” in all courses  
cannot be graduated**



Remedy: SGS allows a student to retake  
a course at most twice if Grade  $\leq$  C

*subject to course offering schedule and  
availability*

| GPA of Individual Courses |             |                  |
|---------------------------|-------------|------------------|
| Grade                     | Grade Point | Grade Definition |
| A+                        | 4.3         | Excellent        |
| A                         | 4.0         |                  |
| A-                        | 3.7         |                  |
| B+                        | 3.3         | Good             |
| B                         | 3.0         |                  |
| B-                        | 2.7         |                  |
| C+                        | 2.3         | Adequate         |
| C                         | 2.0         |                  |
| C-                        | 1.7         |                  |
| D                         | 1           | Marginal         |
| F                         | 0           | Fail             |

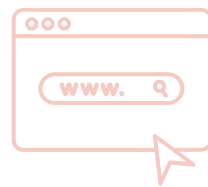
# Graduation Dates & Certificate

The graduation date is determined by your study progress

➡➡➡➡ plan your studies to fulfill your graduation requirements in your preferred semester

After fulfilling all the graduation requirements

➡➡➡➡ **NOT** be allowed to register for any course/ defer your graduation to a later semester



Visit the Chow Yei Ching School of Graduate Studies (SGS) website for details:

<https://www.cityu.edu.hk/sgs/student/masters/info-graduates/awardcert>

| Graduates of       | Graduate Date to be Printed on Award Certificates and Transcript |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Semester A 2026/27 | 1 February 2027                                                  |
| Semester B 2026/27 | 1 June 2027                                                      |
| Summer Term 2027   | 4 October 2027                                                   |
| Semester A 2027/28 | 1 February 2028                                                  |
| Semester B 2027/28 | 1 June 2028                                                      |
| Summer Term 2028   | 3 October 2028                                                   |

*The expected graduation date in AIMS will be adjusted automatically according to your study progress*

# Graduation Dates & Certificate



Official award title:

**“Master of Science in Artificial Intelligence 人工智能理學碩士”**

Graduation certificate will be issued by the Chow Yei Ching School of Graduate Studies (SGS)

- SGS will send email notifications of collection to you
- Usually **a few weeks after** you have passed **all** the courses of the degree

When you complete all the courses with grades released, you may apply a testimonial from SGS: <https://www.cityu.edu.hk/sgs/student/tpg>

- Note: It is not a graduation certification.



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# Tuition Fees



Access your own account summary in AIMS

**MUST** pay all fees and charges by the payment due date



Students who do not pay the fees and charges in full by the payment due date:

- May be barred from accessing University facilities
- Termination of studies
  - Refer to clauses 5.9 - 5.11 of the Regulations on Tuition Fees ([http://www.cityu.edu.hk/fo/htm/Tuition\\_Fees.htm](http://www.cityu.edu.hk/fo/htm/Tuition_Fees.htm))



A late payment charge of 2% on the outstanding balance +  
Reinstatement charge



# Visa Extension

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Student visa requirement:     | Non-local students studying in Hong Kong must hold a valid student visa throughout the entire study period                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Extension of stay:            | If the stay granted by the Immigration Department is shorter than your programme duration, apply for an extension <b>four weeks before</b> your current visa/entry permit expires                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Reporting visa information:   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• You must report new visa details to the Chow Yei Ching School of Graduate Studies (SGS)</li><li>• Failure to do so will result in being considered ineligible for study and losing access to the Library, Computer Service Centre, CityUHK Portal, and AIMS</li><li>• All registered courses will be de-registered if you cannot provide a valid visa</li></ul> |
| After applying for extension: | Submit a copy of your extended student visa or the acknowledgement letter from the Immigration Department to SGS at <a href="mailto:tpenquir@cityu.edu.hk">tpenquir@cityu.edu.hk</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Enquiries:                    | Contact the Admissions Office (ADMO) at <a href="mailto:admovisa@cityu.edu.hk">admovisa@cityu.edu.hk</a> or visit their <a href="https://www.cityu.edu.hk/admo/faq#heading-accordion-18641-7">https://www.cityu.edu.hk/admo/faq#heading-accordion-18641-7</a> for details                                                                                                                               |

# Take-home Message



**Credit Transfer and Course Exemption Deadline: 28 August 2026**



**Course Add/ Drop Deadline (Sem A): 7 September 2026**



**Attend all classes physically in campus**



**Read and respond to the CityUHK emails timely**



**Academic Honesty: NO cheating and plagiarism**



# Key Contacts



**Prof. ZHANG Qingfu**

Programme Leader

✉ qingfu.zhang@cityu.edu.hk



**Prof. LIAO Jing**

Deputy Programme Leader

✉ jingliao@cityu.edu.hk

✉ Programme email: [csmsai@cityu.edu.hk](mailto:csmsai@cityu.edu.hk)

# Academic/Admin Support Units & Links

Who you can contact and what each unit handles



## Department of Computer Science

Programme home dept,  
staff and course info



## Computer Science (CS) Lab

Printing quota:  
1000 B&W, 50 colour



## Computer Services Centre

Campus IT accounts,  
network and support



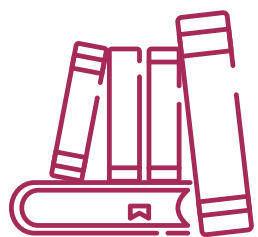
## School of Graduate Studies

Registration, records, transcripts, visa  
extension, FAQ



## Finance Office

Tuition fees and payment matters



## Library

Collections, study space,  
university printing service



## Careers & Leadership (SDS)

Postgraduate career  
service and coaching



## Student Residence Office

Halls and off-campus  
accommodation



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**Wish you every  
success in  
your study!**